How a university application proceeds

These are the high-level steps Lantern follows with a customer for a Bachelor or a Master in Germany. We do the steps in this order. We do not jump to the visa before there is an admission letter.

1	**First message** **Customer** The customer sends the highest qualification, marks, English or German level, the subject, and the intake. They also say Bachelor or Master.
2	**Choose the path** **Lantern** We confirm Bachelor or Master. An Ausbildung is a company training application, so it does not follow these university steps.
3	**Check the profile** **Lantern** We look at marks, language, study gaps, and budget. If the path is not realistic, we say so before any documents are prepared.
4	**Pay the fee** **Customer** The one-time fee is 16000 rupees. It is paid once, before the written plan starts. University fees are separate.
5	**Shortlist** **Lantern** We send 5 to 8 programmes that fit the profile, with the real deadline and the portal for each one. The university page decides the date.
6	**Document list** **Lantern** We list what that programme asks for: passport, transcripts, language proof, CV, and motivation letter. Some countries also need APS. We check that rule for the customer's country.
7	**Review the writing** **Both** The customer writes the CV and motivation letter in their own words. Lantern reads them and points out what is unclear.
8	**Submit the application** **Customer** The customer creates the account and submits. Some universities use uni-assist. Others use their own portal. Lantern can guide the clicks on a call. Lantern does not keep the password.
9	**Check before the deadline** **Both** We compare the uploaded file with the university list and name anything still missing. The customer uploads the missing item.
10	**Wait for the decision** **University** The university accepts, rejects, or asks for more papers. Lantern cannot promise an offer.
11	**Open the visa file** **Both** Only after a real admission letter do we open the embassy checklist. The visa step does not start from a shortlist.

Lantern is not a university and not the embassy. The customer submits every application in their own name. The one-time guidance fee is 16000 rupees. The blocked account, visa fee, translations, and semester fees are paid by the customer to those offices.